making out that there would be no subsequent transfer of the Afghan material. The reporter himself didn't care about exclusivity, but was aware, understandably, that his bosses would. We agreed that we would control the embargo date and ensure, for legal reasons as well as the commercial ones they would have in mind, that the material would come out at the same time. We also agreed that each paper would have editorial control over its own content. Television might be brought in at the last minute but not before, as the nature of television production would make it impossible to keep the impending leak secret. We had no dispute over this: it was my plan and I laid it out, and he nodded it through with contained excitement. The reporter deserves credit for how he managed things at that point: he acted like an activist, which was close to his roots, and strategised about how to give the material its best platforms.

I was seeking to set up a WikiLeaks production unit for this massive project in Stockholm. That was proving difficult – after 'Collateral Murder', the level of heat on me as the main public face of WikiLeaks was intense, and some personnel shied away – but the investigations guy and I met in Stockholm and continued to talk over the plan. At this point another *Guardian* reporter came into the picture. I'd met him before, in Oslo, I think, where he had seen the Baghdad video in a rough form and had wanted to buy it for his paper. We were being too heavily monitored then, so nothing came of it, but it probably fed into my notion that the *Guardian* would be a natural collaborator when the time came. Suddenly, this reporter – a news guy – took a role on behalf of the *Guardian*, the Afghan material was transferred to him and he proceeded to share it with the *New York Times*, as agreed by myself and his colleague.

You've got to imagine this stuff in its raw form. There were around 90,000 discrete entries in the Afghanistan field logs (we eventually released about 75,000), and they had been made on the spot, after every skirmish or battle or IED explosion. They were full of acronyms and army-speak. One entry, picked entirely at random, begins: '(M) KAF PRT reports finding rocket IVO KAF PRT Site.' The *New York Times*, in its literal-mindedness and impatience, couldn't see the narrative, and took a while to understand the forces at work in the material, the sheer statistical and human horde it represented; they were at first disappointed not to see 'the stories'. The *Guardian*'s news reporter, a senior guy, at this point showed his first manipulative little impulse: he said the *New York Times*, in order to stay on